

PSIR 201 -Fall 2024

5 February 2025 - CL 202

Resit Examination - Total Points: 75; Duration: 90 minutes

Section 1: Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) (30 points total)

1. Which of the following is a core assumption of realism, particularly in the context of international conflict?
 - ☐ a) States are the only relevant actors in international relations.
 - ☐ b) International institutions are more important than state power.
 - ☐ c) Human nature is inherently cooperative.
 - ☐ d) Global anarchy promotes peace.
2. Which theory focuses on the social construction of reality in international relations?
 - ☐ a) Realism
 - ☐ b) Liberalism
 - ☐ c) Constructivism
 - ☐ d) English School
3. Which international agreement is most closely associated with the neoliberal institutionalist approach to climate change?
 - ☐ a) The Kyoto Protocol
 - ☐ b) The Treaty of Westphalia
 - ☐ c) The Abraham Accords
 - ☐ d) The Camp David Accords
4. "World-systems theory" is a concept primarily associated with:
 - ☐ a) Liberalism
 - ☐ b) Marxism
 - ☐ c) Realism
 - ☐ d) Postcolonialism
5. The "Responsibility to Protect" (R2P) norm has shaped international responses to humanitarian crises. It is most aligned with which theoretical approach?
 - ☐ a) Realism
 - ☐ b) Liberalism
 - ☐ c) Constructivism
 - ☐ d) Marxism
6. Which institution was created as a result of the Bretton Woods Conference?
 - ☐ a) The United Nations
 - ☐ b) The World Bank
 - ☐ c) NATO
 - ☐ d) The European Union
7. According to realists, what is the primary goal of states in the international system?
 - ☐ a) To promote global peace and cooperation.
 - ☐ b) To maximize their power and security.
 - ☐ c) To foster economic interdependence.
 - ☐ d) To establish a global government.
8. Which theory emphasizes the role of shared norms and values in shaping state behavior?
 - ☐ a) Realism
 - ☐ b) Liberalism
 - ☐ c) Constructivism
 - ☐ d) Marxism
9. Which of these is a key concept in the English School of international relations?
 - ☐ a) Balance of Power
 - ☐ b) International System
 - ☐ c) Hegemonic Stability
 - ☐ d) Democratic Peace
10. Poststructuralism emphasizes the importance of what in understanding international relations?
 - ☐ a) material capabilities
 - ☐ b) discourse and language
 - ☐ c) economic structures
 - ☐ d) state sovereignty
11. Which theory would emphasize the role of gender in analyzing war?
 - ☐ a) Realism
 - ☐ b) Liberalism
 - ☐ c) Feminism
 - ☐ d) Marxism
12. Which of the following is a core concept in Marxism?
 - ☐ a) The balance of power
 - ☐ b) The social contract
 - ☐ c) Class struggle
 - ☐ d) Democratic Peace
13. Which theory highlights the importance of historical context in understanding international relations?
 - ☐ a) Realism
 - ☐ b) Liberalism
 - ☐ c) Constructivism
 - ☐ d) Postcolonialism

14. What does the term "securitization" refer to in international relations?

- a) The process of disarmament.
- b) The framing of issues as existential threats.
- c) The promotion of global trade.
- d) The creation of international organizations.

15. What does the concept of "relationality" suggest in the context of Chinese IR?

- a) States always act in self-interest.
- b) States' actions are based on their relations with others.
- c) International anarchy is the defining feature of world politics.
- d) The focus should be on individual rights.

16. The concept of "ecological space" as a human right is most closely associated with which theory?

- a) Realism
- b) Liberalism
- c) Green Theory
- d) Critical Theory

17. Which theorist is known for the concept of the "knowledge-power nexus"?

- a) Karl Marx
- b) Michel Foucault
- c) Immanuel Kant
- d) Hans Morgenthau

18. What does the term "othering" refer to in the context of postcolonial theory?

- a) The promotion of cultural exchange.
- b) The construction of identities as different and inferior.
- c) The process of economic integration.
- d) The strengthening of state sovereignty.

19. What is the main focus of queer theory in international relations?

- a) State security
- b) Gender and sexual norms
- c) Economic development
- d) Environmental protection

20. The idea of a "global IR" primarily challenges the dominance of what perspective in the field?

- a) Realism
- b) Western
- c) Marxist
- d) Constructivist

21. According to the English School, what are "institutions"?

- a) International organizations such as the UN
- b) Long-term practices among states, like diplomacy
- c) Economic agreements
- d) Military alliances

22. What is the core belief of liberalism regarding international relations?

- a) Conflict is inevitable
- b) Cooperation and peace are achievable
- c) States should always prioritize their own interests
- d) International institutions are ineffective

23. Which concept is central to constructivism's understanding of international politics?

- a) Material capabilities
- b) Shared norms and values
- c) The balance of power
- d) State sovereignty

24. What is the main focus of critical theory in international relations?

- a) Understanding state behavior
- b) Promoting emancipation and justice
- c) Analyzing economic systems
- d) Maintaining international order

25. What does the term "historical materialism" refer to in Marxist theory?

- a) The study of past political events
- b) The material conditions shaping society and politics
- c) The analysis of ideas and norms
- d) The role of great leaders in history

26. Which of the following is a core idea in postcolonial theory?

- a) The importance of national identity
- b) The legacy of colonialism on power relations
- c) The benefits of globalization
- d) The primacy of state interests

27. What is meant by the term "the security dilemma"?

- a) States always act peacefully
- b) States can never achieve true security
- c) Actions taken to increase security are perceived as a threat by others
- d) International cooperation is not possible

28. Which of the following is a key claim made by poststructuralists?

- a) The state is a rational actor
- b) Power is dispersed through discourse
- c) Objective truth exists
- d) Material capabilities are the main determinant in international relations

29. What is the main argument of dependency theory?

- a) Developed states rely on each other for growth
- b) Wealthy states exploit developing countries
- c) All states benefit equally from free trade
- d) Developing countries should prioritize economic growth over all other concerns

30. What does the Polluter Pays Principle advocate for in the context of climate change?

- a) Wealthy states should bear the brunt of climate change action
- b) Those responsible for pollution should pay for the damage
- c) All states should contribute equally
- d) Developed states should provide financial aid to developing ones

Section 2: Short Answer Questions (20 points total): choose and answer any TWO (2) questions from the list below:

- Each question is worth 10 points.
- 1. Explain the concept of the "security dilemma" in realism and how it perpetuates conflict.
- 2. How does the constructivist understanding of "anarchy" differ from the realist view?
- 3. What is the "knowledge-power nexus" according to poststructuralism, and how does it impact international relations?
- 4. Describe the main critique that feminism brings to the study of international relations and provide an example.
- 5. Explain the concept of "dependency theory" and its significance in Marxist IR.
- 6. How does the English School's concept of "international society" differ from the realist notion of anarchy?

Section 3: Essay Questions (25 points total)

- Answer **one (1)** of the following questions.
- 1. Analyze the Cold War as a case study using realism and constructivism. How do these theories explain its key dynamics and outcomes? Then, apply these insights to a recent geopolitical event, such as the Russia-Ukraine conflict, to explore continuities and changes in global power politics.
- 2. Discuss the main criticisms of traditional IR theory from feminist and postcolonial perspectives. How do these perspectives offer new insights into international relations? Be sure to give examples.

Internal Answer Sheet for Instructor

This section is intended for the instructor's use only.

Section 1: Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

1. a
2. c
3. a
4. b
5. b
6. b
7. b
8. c
9. b
10. b
11. c
12. c
13. d
14. b
15. b
16. c
17. b
18. b
19. b
20. b
21. b
22. b
23. b
24. b
25. b
26. b
27. c
28. b
29. b
30. b

Section 2: Short Answer Questions

1. **Security Dilemma:** In realism, the security dilemma refers to the paradox that when one state increases its security measures (like arming itself), it can make other states feel less secure, leading them to build up their own defenses. This creates a cycle of arms build-up and mutual distrust, thereby perpetuating conflict.

2. **Constructivist Anarchy:** Realists view anarchy as a condition of chaos and competition in the international system, where states are always looking to increase power. Constructivists see anarchy as a social construct, meaning its interpretation depends on how states perceive it. They argue it is not an objective reality, but “what states make of it”.
3. **Knowledge-Power Nexus:** According to poststructuralism, the knowledge-power nexus is the idea that those in power, such as politicians, media, and scholars, have the ability to shape our common understandings of issues, which in turn can influence what actions are seen as legitimate. Power is knowledge and knowledge is power.
4. **Feminist Critique:** Feminism critiques the male-dominated nature of IR, noting that traditional theories ignore or marginalize women’s experiences, and often focus on war and security from a male perspective. An example could be the lack of female representation in peace negotiations and peacekeeping missions.
5. **Dependency Theory:** Dependency theory, a Marxist concept, argues that wealthy, core countries exploit developing, peripheral countries through economic and political mechanisms. This dependency prevents peripheral countries from achieving true development.
6. **English School and International Society:** The English School's concept of "international society" involves states being bound by a set of common rules and institutions, while realism focuses on the state of international anarchy, where no such rules exist.
7. **Constructivism's Key Factor:** According to constructivism, the key factor in shaping international relations is shared ideas, norms, and values. For example, the relationship of enmity between North Korea and the US has changed over time due to these shared ideas.
8. **Neoliberal Institutionalism:** International organizations, for neoliberal institutionalists, help foster cooperation by monitoring agreements and reducing the incentive to defect. This contrasts with realism, which is skeptical of the effectiveness of international institutions.
9. **Constructivist Critique of Realism:** Constructivists argue that realism’s focus on material power and state-centric views neglects the role of ideas and norms. Constructivists claim that the way states interpret anarchy affects their behavior, not just the presence of anarchy.
10. **Postcolonial Theory Example:** Postcolonial theory explains contemporary international relations by highlighting how historical power dynamics rooted in colonialism continue to shape relationships between nations, for instance in the global distribution of resources or in discussions of which states can be trusted with nuclear weapons.
11. **Soft Power:** False. Soft power relies on cultural and political influence, not solely on military strength.
12. **Identity in Constructivism:** Identity, in constructivism, refers to a state's understanding of who they are, which shapes their interests and actions. For example, Germany’s post-WWII identity as pacifist influenced its non-military stance.
13. **R2P:** The Responsibility to Protect (R2P) norm stipulates that states have a responsibility to protect their populations from mass atrocities, and if they fail to do so, the international community has a responsibility to intervene. R2P is aligned with constructivism and liberalism.

14. **Securitization Theory:** Securitization theory explains the framing of non-traditional threats by showing how decision-makers use language to present issues like pandemics or climate change as existential threats that require extraordinary measures and transcend normal political action.
15. **Goals of Global IR:** Global IR aims to challenge the Western bias in the field, and incorporate the experiences and voices of the non-Western world, or the Global South. It promotes a more inclusive understanding of international relations.
16. **Green Theory:** Green Theory challenges the state-centric approach and promotes an understanding that prioritizes the environment and ecological sustainability. It focuses on how the environment and environmental issues impact international relations.
17. **Buffalo Treaty:** The Buffalo Treaty signifies Indigenous self-determination and a revitalization of treaties that involve diplomacy with the natural world, representing a challenge to state sovereignty and a resurgence of traditional relationships with the land.
18. **Classical Realism and Politics:** Classical realists view domestic and international politics as interconnected. They focus on how human drives influence political communities at all levels, shaping power dynamics and state behavior.
19. **Reification:** In the context of IR theories, reification refers to the process where theories and concepts become rigid and detached from their historical, social, and geopolitical origins. It also means assuming current socio-political reality cannot be fundamentally altered.
20. **Particularistic vs. Pluralistic Universalism:** Particularistic universalism is the idea that one set of ideas (often Western) should apply universally, whereas pluralistic universalism respects diverse ideas and seeks common ground among different worldviews.

Section 3: Essay Questions

- **Essay 1 (Cold War Analysis):**
 - **Realism:** Realism would explain the Cold War through the lens of a power struggle between the US and the USSR, driven by their respective desires for power and security in a system characterized by anarchy. The security dilemma and the need for a balance of power played key roles in the arms race and proxy wars.
 - **Constructivism:** Constructivism would highlight the ideological competition and the construction of identities of the US and the USSR as rivals. The perception of each other as enemies and the spread of ideologies (democracy vs. communism) played a major role in shaping the conflict.
 - **Continuities/Changes:** Applying these theories to the Russia-Ukraine conflict reveals some continuities (power struggles, security dilemmas), and some changes (the nature of ideological conflicts, the rise of non-state actors).
- **Essay 2 (Feminist/Postcolonial Critiques):**
 - **Feminist Critique:** Feminism criticizes traditional IR theories for ignoring gender and women's experiences. It highlights the gendered nature of war and conflict, as well as the male-dominated structures of international politics. Examples could include the underrepresentation of women in peace processes or the use of gender-based violence as a tactic of war.

- **Postcolonial Critique:** Postcolonialism critiques the Western-centric nature of IR, highlighting how colonial legacies continue to influence global power dynamics. It focuses on the power of "othering" and how racialized discourses affect international relations. Examples could include the power dynamics in nuclear proliferation or the ongoing impact of Western institutions on developing nations.

This internal answer sheet is intended to provide guidance for the instructor in evaluating the exam. It is not intended to be exhaustive, and the instructor should use their judgment in assessing students' responses.